

Lockheed F-104A Starfighter

Kelly Johnson of Lockheed believed US aircraft in the Korean War were too heavy, so he sold the idea of a lightweight fighter to the US Air Force and produced this extraordinary "missile with a man in it." While it was very fast – breaking the world speed record in 1958 – it had very short range and poor maneuverability due to its small wings.



ENGINE 14,800lb (6,713kg) thrust GE J79-GE-3 turbojet

WINGSPAN 21ft 11in (6.7m) **LENGTH** 54ft 9in (16.7m)

TOP SPEED 1,450mph (2,330kph) (Mach 2.2) **CREW** 1

ARMAMENT 1 x M-61 20mm rotary cannon in fuselage;
2 x Sidewinder air-to-air missiles on wing tips

McDonnell F-101B Voodoo

The Voodoo was originally intended as a supersonic escort for the B-36 bomber but, when it became clear that the range could not be achieved, it was developed into a tactical, nuclear-strike aircraft. From this came the F-101B all-weather interceptor, with the latest "collision course" radar fire-control system. This version entered service in 1959 and over 400 were delivered. Although fast and heavily armed, it was never easy to fly; about a fifth were lost in crashes. It was phased out by 1970.



15,000lb thrust Pratt & Whitney turbojet with afterburner

ENGINE 2 x 15,000lb (6,800kg) thrust P&W J57-P-55 turbojet

WINGSPAN 39ft 8in (12.1m) **LENGTH** 67ft 4in (20.6m)

TOP SPEED 1,220mph (1,963kph) (Mach 1.85) **CREW** 2

ARMAMENT 3 x Falcon guided air-to-air missiles in fuselage bay,
2 x Genie nuclear-tipped, unguided air-to-air rockets

Mikoyan-Gurevich MiG-17 "Fresco"



Tailpipe of engine afterburner

Radio antenna

Air-data boom, including pitot head

High-speed handling problems that limited the effectiveness of the MiG-15 were largely eliminated in the MiG-17, introduced in 1952. Although it was claimed that the prototype exceeded Mach 1 in level flight, production models could not quite achieve this. During the Vietnam War (1961–73) – although by then technically obsolete – the MiG-17 gave a good account of itself against heavily-laden US attack aircraft. Around 8,000 MiG-17s of all types were produced, with licensed production in Poland, Czechoslovakia, and China.

ENGINE 7,452lb (3,380kg) thrust Klimov VK-1F turbojet

WINGSPAN 31ft (9.5m) **LENGTH** 36ft 3in (11.1m)

TOP SPEED 711mph (1,145kph) **CREW** 1

ARMAMENT 1 x 37mm and 2 x 23mm cannon under nose

Mikoyan-Gurevich MiG-19S "Farmer"

The first Soviet production fighter to go supersonic, it was either just beaten by or just preceded the American F-100 as the world's first, depending on whose account you read. Whatever the truth, by late 1954 the Soviet air force was receiving MiG-19s just as the USAF was getting Super Sabres. Exported to many of the Soviet Union's allies and client states, the MiG-19 saw action in Vietnam and an improved Chinese-built version continued in production for many years.

ENGINE 2 x 6,700lb (3,040kg) thrust Mikulin AM-5 turbojet

WINGSPAN 29ft 6in (9m) **LENGTH** 41ft 2in (12.5m)

TOP SPEED 903mph (1,452kph) (Mach 1.4) **CREW** 1

ARMAMENT 3 x 30mm cannon and missiles or rockets



Saab J35A Draken

This versatile high performance fighter was a key part of the very advanced Swedish air defense system in the 1960s and 1970s. The Draken had a unique "double delta" wing shape, which gave both maneuverability and exceptional takeoff and landing performance.



ENGINE 15,200lb (6,895kg) thrust Svenska Flygmotor RM6B

WINGSPAN 30ft 10in (9.4m) **LENGTH** 52ft 4in (16m)

TOP SPEED 1,190mph (1,915kph) (Mach 1.8) **CREW** 1

ARMAMENT 2 x 30mm Aden cannon; 4 x Sidewinder missiles

Yakovlev Yak-28P "Firebar"



The original Yak-28 was an attack bomber, with a bombardier carried in a glazed nose. It was converted to an all-weather interceptor by installing a dual cockpit and filling the nose with interception and guidance radar. The fuselage bomb-bay became fuel tanks, so the Yak-28P had useful range to patrol Russia's Arctic border, in case of an attack over the North Pole from America. Over 400 aircraft were delivered from 1962; they were eventually replaced by the Sukhoi Su-27.

ENGINE 2 x 13,700lb (6,200kg) thrust Tumanskii R-11F turbojet

WINGSPAN 38ft 2in (11.6m) **LENGTH** 70ft 5in (21.5m)

TOP SPEED 1,280mph (2,060kph) (Mach 1.94) **CREW** 2

ARMAMENT 2 x AA-3 guided air-to-air missiles under wings